THE GOOD NEWS

United Presbyterian Church

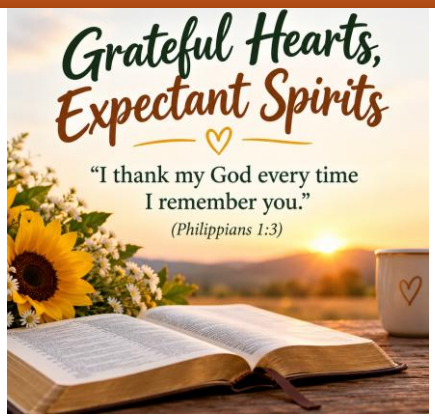
525 East Front Street Plainfield, NJ 07060
908-756-2666 | http://www.upcplainfield.com

Where God is exalted, Everyone matters, and You belong!

Worship Services: Sunday 11:00 am & Thursdays 7:30 pm

November 2026

PASTOR'S MESSAGE
Allegra Hoots, MDiv



Dear Friends and Family,

Greetings to you in the mighty, matchless, and holy name of the Lord Jesus Christ, our blessed Redeemer. As always, I trust God that this letter finds you rejoicing in the Lord and experiencing the peace of Christ that surpasses human understanding.

Let me begin by saying, **"Thank you."**

As we enter November, Paul's words to the Philippians express what is in my heart: "*I thank my God every time I remember you.*" This is certainly a season for giving thanks, but gratitude is more than something we practice around the Thanksgiving table. For God's people, gratitude is a way to recognize God's presence, goodness, and faithfulness in every season of our lives.

And right now, I have much for which to be grateful.

On Sunday, October 25, you surprised and blessed me with a wonderful Pastor Appreciation Day celebration. I hardly know how to adequately express how deeply I was touched by the outpouring of love you showed me.

Thank you for the gifts, the poems, the heartfelt tributes from our young people, the kind words, and the soul-stirring singing of my favorite hymn by Elder Marcia Marsh-Hinds. Each expression of appreciation was meaningful, but what touched me most was the love behind it all.

And then God gave us an unexpected bonus! Elder Emory Dawson's sisters were visiting him and worshiping with us that Sunday, and they added to the celebration by blessing us with two beautiful songs of praise. Their ministry in song, accompanied by our own beloved Sue Terry, was a wonderful addition to an already beautiful day.

I thank you for making me feel so loved and appreciated. But even more, I thank God for you and for the privilege of serving as your pastor.

Ministry is not something a pastor does alone. We worship together. We pray together. We learn together. We serve together. Sometimes we struggle together, and by the grace of God, we grow together. We are the Body of Christ, and each of us has a place in that body and gifts to offer.

As I received your expressions of appreciation, I was reminded once again of how grateful I am that God has called us to walk this portion of our Christian journey together.

Even as I give thanks for what God has already done among us, I find myself looking forward with expectation to what lies ahead. Before long, we will enter the season of Advent, that sacred season of watching, waiting, preparing, and expecting. Amid all the activity that accompanies the Christmas season, Advent invites us to slow down, pay attention, and prepare our hearts anew for the coming of Christ.

This year, we will have several opportunities to do just that through our upcoming Advent Workshops for youth ages 6 to 16 and our weekly Adult Advent Study on Sunday evenings at 7:30 p.m. I hope you will make these opportunities part of your family's Advent journey.

Cont'd. on page 4



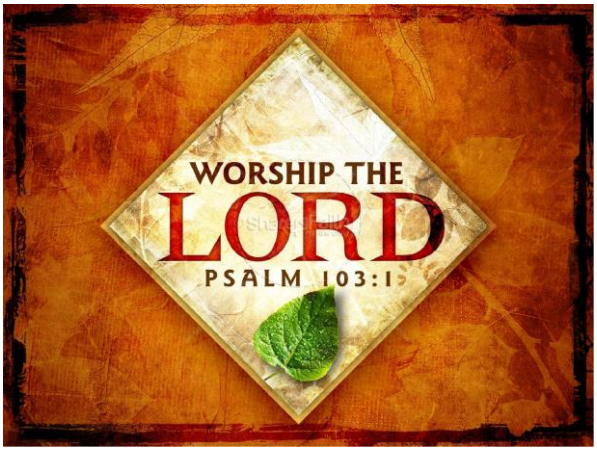
Pastor Allegra Hoots

Sundays at 11:00am
In the Sanctuary &
Via YouTube (https://bit.ly/3jyylpg)

Contemporary Worship Service
Thursdays @ 7:30pm—Via YouTube
https://bit.ly/3J7whly

Daily Devotions
Mondays to Fridays ~ 6:00am to 6:15am
Via Zoom: https://bit.ly/40BeoBK)

Daily Scripture Reading
upcc.app





INVITING ALL

Elementary, Junior & High School Students

Sundays at 10:00am

** Classes will be held every Sunday **
unless specified otherwise.

Rooms are located by the Church Office

- Call the Church Office for more info or for transportation -

Jesus said, "Let the children come to me and do not stop them, because the Kingdom of heaven belongs to such as these."

Matthew 19:14

Daylight Saving Time Ends November 1st at 2am (turn clocks back to 1am).

Upcoming Events **See calendars for more activities and events**

November

Date	Time	Event
1		All Saints Day
		Daylight Savings Time Ends
3		Election Day (General Election)
18	7:30pm	Session Meeting
26		Thanksgiving Day
29		Advent begins

December

Date	Time	Event
5	11am-1pm	Youth Advent Workshop
20	11:am	Christmas Service
24	7:00pm	Christmas (Eve) Service
26		Kwanzaa
31	11:00pm	New Year's Eve (Watch night) Service

FOR VIRTUAL EVENTS:
TO CONNECT BY COMPUTER OR TELEPHONE, GO TO THE CHURCH'S WEBSITE FOR INFORMATION:
http://www.upcplainfield.com/

New Jersey Elections, 2026

Voting is not merely a right; it is a responsibility and privilege that each eligible citizen should embrace. By participating in elections, you play an active role in shaping the future of your community and country. Your vote carries the power to influence policies, hold leaders accountable, and create a more inclusive society. It is essential to remember that voting is not only about your individual voice but also about contributing to the collective voice of the people. By exercising your right to vote, you are strengthening democracy and ensuring that everyone has a chance to be heard.

Whether you are young or old, your vote matters.
Use it to make a positive impact on the world around you!

New Jersey elections, 2026	
Office	**Elections?**
U.S. Senate	✓
U.S. House	✓
Congress special election	✓
School boards	✓
Municipal government	✓

https://ballotpedia.org/New_Jersey_elections,_2026



Crawford Walton
Memorial Fund

DONATE: https://bit.ly/3Qr2Xg9

The Board of Deacons of the United Presbyterian Church of Plainfield is accepting donations for the Crawford/Walton Memorial Fund for higher education.

This fund provides scholarships to members pursuing an undergraduate degree, as well as members pursuing a seminary degree.

Donations are accepted and welcomed to this fund at any time and may be accomplished by:

1. Sending a check, made out to the:
   United Presbyterian Church of Plainfield; c/o Treasurer
   525 East Front Street, Plainfield, New Jersey 07060
   In the memo section of the check, write "Crawford-Walton Memorial Fund"

~ OR ~

2. Contributions can be made through the "Donate" button located at the UPC website at https://bit.ly/3Qr2Xg9.
   Enter your contribution to the “Deacons Fund".
   In the notes section indicate "Crawford-Walton Memorial Fund”.

Invest in our children’s future

Pastor's Message Cont'd. from pg 1

The Advent Workshops will provide our young people, ages 6 to 16, with creative and meaningful ways to experience the season, while our Adult Advent Study will give us an opportunity to gather around Scripture, reflect together, and consider what it means to prepare not simply our homes for Christmas, but our hearts for Christ.

I encourage our young people and adults alike to participate in the opportunities prepared especially for them, and I invite you to encourage someone else to join us. Advent is approaching, and I am excited about what God has in store for us as we journey toward the manger together.

So, as we begin November, perhaps these can be our watchwords:

Give thanks.
Stay encouraged.
Prepare your heart.
Expect God.

Whatever this month brings, let us remember we do not walk through it alone. God has been faithful. God is with us now. And we can trust God with whatever lies ahead.

UPC family, thank you for your prayers, encouragement, faithfulness, and love. Thank you again for the extraordinary expressions of appreciation you shared with me. The gifts were wonderful, but the greatest gift was the love behind them.

And so, I end where I began: "I thank my God every time I remember you."

I thank God for you. I thank God for the privilege of serving you. And I look forward with joy and expectation to all that God will continue to do in us, through us, and among us.

May the grace of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ sustain us, the love of God surround us, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit keep us as we continue this journey of faith together.

With a grateful heart and much love,

Allegra Hoots

Advent

Nov. 29th to Dec 24th , 2026



Advent is a sacred season of waiting, prayer, and preparation observed in many Christian traditions. It marks the start of the Christian liturgical year, spanning the four Sundays leading up to Christmas Eve.

It looks back in remembrance of Jesus Christ's first coming as a baby in Bethlehem and looks forward in anticipation of His Second Coming at the end of time.

Core Symbols and Traditions

The Advent Wreath: A circular ring made of evergreen branches symbolizing eternal life.

The Five Candles: Four purple or blue candles are lit each of the four Sundays of Advent representing themes of hope, peace, joy and love. The white candle is lit on Christmas Eve or Christmas day representing the birth of Jesus. Alongside the lighting of the candles are scripture readings, responsive litanies, and prayer.

Participation: Families, children, or designated members of the congregation often read the parts and light the candles during the service.

https://pcusa.org/resource/lighting-advent-candles-general

If you have the chance to make people happy, just do it. Sometimes people are struggling silently. Maybe, your act of kindness can make their day.

CONGRATULATIONS

Congratulations to Wolfgang Bofah !
He was accepted to Montclair State University and waitlisted to New Jersey Institute of Technology (NJIT)

In January 2027, he'll transfer to NJIT.
His major will be Computer Engineering.





Thursday, November 26, 2026

What should be the focus of Christians on Thanksgiving?

Christians express gratitude for their blessings on Thanksgiving...

QUESTION

I'm a university student from another country, and in our society, we don't have anything like your holiday of Thanksgiving. Does it have something to do with your Christian religion?

ANSWER

Giving thanks to God for all His blessings is an important part of our Christian faith, and especially at Thanksgiving we remember this. The Bible (which we believe is God's written word) urges us to be "always giving thanks to God the Father for everything, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ" (Ephesians 5:20).

Although we've been greatly influenced as a nation by the Christian faith, not all Americans take their faith seriously or identify themselves as Christians. Thanksgiving, therefore, is a time for all of us — regardless of our faith — to reflect on the good things we enjoy, and express gratitude for our family and friends.

However, Thanksgiving is a special day of celebration for those of us who are Christians. We know that all our blessings come from God, and everything He gives us is a sign of His goodness and love for us. Most of all, we give thanks for Jesus Christ, who gave His life so we could be cleansed of our sins and go to be with God in heaven forever. The Bible says, "Every good and perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father" (James 1:17).

I welcome you to our country, and during your time here I hope that some committed Christians will become your friends. More than that, I pray you will take time to find out who Jesus is and discover the difference He can make in your life. I encourage you to get a Bible and read about Jesus in one of the Gospels.

Find peace with God today.

https://billygraham.org/answers/christians-express-gratitude-for-their-blessings-on-thanksgiving

Core Purpose

The holiday is a time for family, friends, and communities to gather, share a meal, and express gratitude for the blessings of the past year.

History and Origins

- **The 1621 Feast:** The holiday traditionally traces back to a harvest celebration in 1621 at Plymouth Colony (in modern-day Massachusetts), shared between the English Pilgrims and the Wampanoag people.
- **National Recognition:** While colonial leaders occasionally declared local days of thanksgiving, writer Sarah Josepha Hale campaigned for 36 years to make it a unified national observance, leading to Lincoln's 1863 proclamation during the Civil War to foster national unity.
- **Perspectives:** While many Americans view it as a joyful family tradition, some Indigenous people and Native Americans view Thanksgiving with mixed or painful feelings, considering it a reminder of the colonization, disease, and land loss that followed.

Common Traditions

- **The Meal:** Families typically prepare a large feast centered around roast turkey, stuffing, mashed potatoes with gravy, cranberry sauce, and pumpkin pie.
- **Service:** Many people use the day to volunteer at food pantries or donate to charitable causes.

The above information was gathered from numerous areas on the internet.





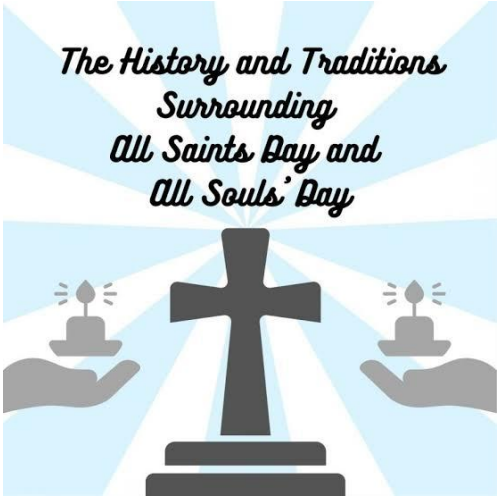
Walk with Jesus

Take a walk and imagine what it would be like if Jesus suddenly appeared on the sidewalk or path in front of you. What would you say? What might he say to you? Imagine Jesus walking along beside you as you go. How would you feel? Knowing Jesus truly is with you wherever you go, how might you carry that feeling of walking together into your daily life?

Annonymous



FOR LAUGHS! There was a preacher who fell in the ocean and he couldn't swim. When a boat came by, the captain yelled, "Do you need help, sir?" The preacher calmly said "No, God will save me." A little later, another boat came by and a fisherman asked, "Hey, do you need help?" The preacher replied again, "No God will save me." Eventually the preacher drowned & went to heaven. The preacher asked God, "Why didn't you save me?" God replied, "Fool, I sent you two boats!"



What Is All Saints Day? (November 1st)

All Saints' Day, also called All Hallows' Day, is celebrated on November 1st in Western Christianity. It honors all saints, known and unknown, who followed Christian teachings. Related observances include All Hallows' Eve (Halloween) on October 31st and All Souls' Day on November 2nd.

The holiday affirms Christians' connection to the church. Although saints may evoke church statues, the Bible teaches that *you are* a saint if you follow Jesus and rely on Christ alone for salvation.

The early Church created All Saints' Day to honor martyrs* and saints who died for their faith, later including all virtuous, faithful Christians to celebrate their shared witness and give thanks for their example. Their graves drew pilgrims; death anniversaries often commemorated their lives and sacrifices.

*"But Ananias answered, "Lord, I have heard from many about this man, how much evil he has done to your **saints** at Jerusalem."* (Acts 9:13)

*"And he who searches hearts knows what is the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the **saints** according to the will of God."* (Romans 8:27)

*"Here is a call for the endurance of the **saints**, those who keep the commandments of God and their faith in Jesus."* (Revelation 14:12)

* A **martyr** is a person who voluntarily suffers death or severe hardship rather than renounce their religious faith,

Happy Birthday Thelma







May God's favor rest upon you and bring you years of deep grace and joy.











Leftover Turkey Soup with Black Beans and Corn

By Elizabeth Lindemann

- 2 Tbs extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 large yellow onion diced
- 1 large bell pepper
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1/2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/4 tsp cayenne pepper
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 tsp kosher salt
- 2 cloves garlic minced
- 4 cups chicken stock/broth or vegetable broth, or turkey stock
- 15 oz. canned black beans drained and rinsed (1.5 cups)
- 1 cup frozen corn
- 2 cups cooked shredded turkey or chicken
- juice and zest of two limes
- 1/2 cup chopped fresh cilantro
- more cilantro, diced red onion, avocado, sour cream, etc. for serving, optional

1. In a large pot, sauté the diced onions and peppers in the olive oil (2 tablespoons) over medium-high heat, until softened and developing deep brown colors, stirring infrequently (5-10 minutes).
2. Add the cumin (1 tsp), smoked paprika (1/2 tsp), cayenne pepper (1/4 tsp), black pepper (1/4 tsp), kosher salt (1/2 tsp), and 2 cloves of minced garlic. Stir until peppers and onions are well-coated and garlic and spices are fragrant (about 1 minute).
3. Add the chicken stock (4 cups). Bring to a boil.
4. Stir in the black beans, frozen corn (1 cup), cooked shredded turkey (2 cups), and lime zest from two limes. Stir and simmer, uncovered, until all ingredients are heated through (about 5 minutes).
5. Turn off the heat. Stir in the lime juice from two limes and the chopped fresh cilantro (1/2 cup). Serve topped with sour cream, avocado, chopped onion, etc., if desired.

https://www.bowlofdelicious.com/leftover-turkey-soup/#recipe

Tinned Fish Is Trending. Here's Why It Makes Sense



Key takeaways

- Salmon and sardines supply heart-healthy omega-3 fats, and their soft, edible bones add calcium.
- Supermarket brands can be just as nutritious as premium tins. A higher price doesn't guarantee greater benefits.
- Sodium levels vary by product, and canned light tuna generally contains less mercury than albacore. Check labels before buying.

Canned fish cuisine has moved well beyond tuna and mayo slapped onto white sandwich bread. Think smoked salmon with chile crisp, sardines in coconut curry and Pacific cod with roasted red pepper sauce.

Canned fish is now showing up in brightly colored tins at specialty food stores and over social media. Shoppers are buying more of it. Tinned fish offers benefits that go well beyond its newfound popularity. It is affordable, shelf-stable, packed with nutrition, easy to chew and can easily be added to traditional meals such as noodles, rice or soup. Private labels [store brands] offer great alternatives to national brands for the same nutrition.

4 reasons canned fish is good for you

Protein for your muscles: A 3-ounce serving of canned fish typically provides about 20 grams of protein.

Calcium for your bones: Don't be too quick to pick the bones out of canned salmon or sardines. The high-heat, high-pressure canning process softens the tiny bones in sardines and salmon until they are completely chewable and digestible..

Omega-3 fats for your heart: Salmon and sardines are rich in EPA and DHA, omega-3 fats that support heart health by reducing triglycerides—blood fats whose high levels can lead to hardened arteries and other cardiovascular diseases.

Vitamin B-12 for your brain: A 3-ounce serving of canned light tuna in water supplies about 2.5 micrograms of B-12, meeting adults' recommended daily intake of 2.4 micrograms. B-12 protects nerve cells essential for balance, memory and other cognitive functions.

What to look for when purchasing tinned fish

Serving size: Check servings per package. Eating a two-serving can doubles the listed sodium, calories and other nutrients. Compare equal portions across products.

Water or oil: Water-packed fish usually has less calories. Oil-packed fish has a richer texture and provides more calories. Check the labels and compare ingredients.

Sodium: Canned fish, especially smoked, brined or flavored varieties, can be high in salt. An ounce of oil-packed boneless anchovies may contain 1,040 milligrams of sodium, versus just 87 milligrams in oil-packed Atlantic sardines.

Mercury: The FDA lists salmon, sardines and canned light tuna among its lower-mercury "best choices." Canned light tuna generally has about one-third as much mercury as canned albacore tuna.

https://www.aarp.org/health/healthy-living/health-benefits-of-tinned-fish/

Remember our brothers and sisters listed. Call or visit if you are able.

Thelma Barnes
Emory Dawson
Joanne Edwards
Lazarus M. Edwards, Sr.
Thelma Fleming
Helen Foerster
O'Harold Hoots
Liz Mangan
Vernel Marsh
Errol Neil
Bobett Neil
Sheila Neil
Yvonne Neil
Marianna Perry
Pat Perry
Brenda Rodgers
Nabila Scott
Gail Stokes
Izaiyah Stokes



Lord, You are the Great Healer.
I lift up the sick before You today.
Touch their body with Your healing hand.
Bring strength where there is weakness.
Replace pain with peace and comfort.
Let hope rise in their spirit again.
Guide the doctors and caregivers with wisdom.
Surround them with love and support.
Restore health and renew life.
In Jesus' name, Amen.



November

6 Sheila Neil
10 Liz Mangan
11 Hilda Bofah
13 James Plummer

December

10 Macy Robinson
13 Javin Scott
16 Yetunde Falowo
18 Avril Lecky
24 Pat Perry
26 Jessica Bofah
Olivia Seelee
27 Gabrielle Greene
29 Jennifer Youngsam



Flower Ministry

With your donation of $25 or more to the Flower Fund, the Deacons will provide a beautiful floral arrangement for the Sanctuary on Sunday mornings. After worship, the arrangement will also brighten the day of a member or friend of UPC who is unable to join us for worship.

Flowers may be given in honor or memory of a loved one. Honoree names will be listed in the church bulletin.

You may complete the form below or add your information to the flower chart in the Narthex.

Blessings,
Zorina Bowers

*Name:*_____

*Email:*_____

Telephone: _____

*Address:*_____

_____

Amount: _____

In Memory of: _____

Thank you for your generous support.
The Board of Deacons

Willing to Serve

Linda L. White (Illinois, USA) 11/22/2026

There are different kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit distributes them. There are different kinds of service, but the same Lord. - 1 Corinthians 12:4-5 (NIV)

Recently some long-standing members left our church, leaving several key volunteer positions empty. There have been notices in the weekly church bulletins, asking congregants to step up to help fill the vacancies. I felt a nudge to help, but my talents are lacking. I have no musical skills, very limited knowledge about operating audio-visual equipment, and the thought of standing up in front of our congregation to speak fills me with dread. I was feeling disappointed and inadequate, but I asked God to show me how I might be of service.

I remembered Paul's words to the Corinthians: "There are different kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit distributes them." I felt that the verse spoke directly to me. If we were all given the same talents and abilities, our world would not function well. It is our differences that make things work.

When it comes to serving others, we can follow Jesus's example. When he lovingly washed his disciples' feet, that act took no special talent-just the desire to be of service. In God's eyes, there is no job too small. All that's required is a willingness to serve.

God did open an opportunity for me at our church, filling a void behind the scenes. Whenever we reach a roadblock, we need only to ask God for guidance to show us the way.

Prayer: Dear Lord, help us remember to always seek your guidance when we face obstacles, knowing that your word leads the way. Amen.

https://www.upperroom.org/devotionals/en-2026-10-22

Liturgists

2026 UPC

A liturgist assists the pastor in leading worship. They may lead congregational participation such as the Call to Worship and the Opening Prayer. Their role is outlined by the Pastor.

January	Daniel Bofah
February	Tania Hemans
March	Al Tate
April	Jean Scott
May	Daniel Bofah
June	Osquit Vanderstoop
July	Yetunde Falowo
August	-------
September	Avril Lecky
October	Marcia Marsh Hinds
November	Yetunde Falowo
December	Al Tate

NOTE: The 2nd Sunday each month is YOUTH SUNDAY. Our youth will assume the role of liturgist.



Have you considered a bequest to United Presbyterian Church?

Over 60% of U.S. adults have no estate planning documents in place.

It has been reported that every week about $100 million is left by people who die without a will.

Your greatest gift is often your legacy gift. People who have been blessed by the United Presbyterian Church have left legacy gifts through their estate. A bequest is one of the easiest gifts to make. As you create or update your will, trust, retirement plan or life insurance, you can specify that a gift goes to United Presbyterian Church.

Your generosity will make a difference in the lives of many individuals.

https://www.cnbc.com/2022/04/11/67percent-of-americans-have-no-estate-plan-heres-how-to-get-started-on-one.html



- Stewardship is managing God's blessings according to His ways and for His glory.
- God is the owner of everything, and we are stewards—managers—of all He has entrusted to us.
- Biblical stewardship is about using your time, talents and resources to serve others and honor God.
- When we understand the honor and responsibility of being a good steward, we're more intentional and generous in how we approach our money, relationships and work.

HAVE YOU PAID YOUR FAMILY'S PER CAPITA FOR 2026?

Understanding per capita

The money contributed helps build up the Body of Christ

GA PER CAPITA RATES		
2026: $11.26	2023: $9.85	2020: $8.95
2025: $10.84	2022: $8.98	2019: $8.95
2024: $9.80	2021: $8.98	2018: $7.73

tithes & offering

Worship the Lord in Giving



To bless the Church with your tithes and offering you may:

1. Drop it off at the church office.
2. Mail your check (not cash) to the church.
3. Log in to https://bit.ly/47YUrdY

   or

4. Go to the UPC website homepage and click on the "**Give Now**" button.

Our gift, no matter how small, goes a very long way to support the church and the community.

~ Thank you ~

Per Capita: Committing to Connection

In addition to your regular offering, please consider contributing $11.26 per family member for 2026. If you are able to give more, your additional contribution can help cover someone who cannot afford their share and would be greatly appreciated.

Per capita connects Presbyterian Church (U.S.A.) congregations and mid councils with the work of the wider church. Per capita is how Presbyterians mutually and equitably share the costs of moving the church forward in the 21st century.

The work of the PC(USA), and in particular the work of the General Assembly, is only possible because members of the church have said they are "all in" and committed to connection through per capita support. It is about joining together as a community and being one body, the body that is Christ's church in the world.

https://pcusa.org/resources/financial-information/capita

WHAT TO DO DURING AN ENCOUNTER WITH IMMIGRATION (ICE)

IF ICE COMES TO YOUR HOME, DO NOT OPEN THE DOOR.

ICE can not enter your home without a search warrant. If the agents say they have a warrant, ask them to pass the warrant to you under the door. Do not open the door. Confirm the name and address on the warrant to make sure it is a valid warrant with your name or someone who lives at your address. Also check that the warrant is signed by a judge. An ICE warrant is not the same as a judicial warrant. During home raids, the agents often say they have a judicial warrant when all they have is an ICE warrant. DOCUMENT WHAT HAPPENED. Ask for the ICE agents' names and badge numbers. Write down and take pictures of everything that happened during the raid.

IF ICE APPROACHES YOU ON THE STREET OR PUBLIC PLACE, ASK: "Am I free to go?" and STAY SILENT.

ICE cannot detain you to question you without a reason. Before giving ICE your name or any information, ask if you are free to go. If they say "yes," leave the location. If they say "no", tell them you don't want to answer any questions and you need to speak to a lawyer. DO NOT AUTHORIZE A SEARCH. If ICE attempts to search you or your property, say "I do not consent to this search." DO NOT RUN. If you run, this could help ICE develop a legal reason to stop you.

REMEMBER:

PREPARE yourself and your family in case you are arrested. Memorize your family's and lawyer's phone numbers. Make emergency plans if you have children or medical needs. Keep copies of important documents with someone you trust.

STAY SILENT. Do not answer any of ICE's questions or give them any information. Anything you say can be used against you.

DO NOT RESIST ARREST. Even if ICE is detaining you wrongfully, do not resist the arrest.

DO NOT LIE OR SHOW FALSE DOCUMENTS. If you are a US Citizen or have lawful status, show proof. If you do not have immigration documents, tell ICE that you want to remain silent. Avoid showing documentation from your home country.

ASK TO SPEAK TO A LAWYER. Do not say anything, and do not make any decisions without speaking to a lawyer.

DO NOT SIGN. The ICE agents could tell you that you need to sign some documents. Do not sign anything until consulting with your lawyer.

YOU CAN RECORD, IF SAFE. If you are not interacting with the ICE/CBP agents and are safe, feel free to record any interactions with the agents, but please announce that you are making a recording and remain at a reasonable distance from such incidents so as not to interfere.

Source: New Jersey Alliance for Immigrant Justice (2016). Know Your Rights Cards.
https://www.njimmigrantjustice.org/know_your_rights_workshops

FOR QUESTIONS OR TO REPORT A RAID, CONTACT LA CASA DE DON PEDRO AT 973-482-8312, ext. 1517.

Courtesy of Star Fish Food Pantry and Plainfield Action Services – 908-753-3519

PLAINFIELD COALITION OF EMERGENCY FOOD PROVIDERS

SOUP KITCHENS/ PREPARED FOOD

St. Mary Church – 516 West Sixth Street: Sundays 3:00 to 4:00 PM
Grace's Kitchen – 600 Cleveland Ave: Last 5 days of the month 11:30 to 1:00 PM
Salvation Army 615 Watchung Avenue: Monday, Wednesday & Thursday 12:00-1:00 PM
The Lord's Kitchen 515 West 4th Street: Wednesday & Thursday 4:00 PM-6:00 PM
Muslim Community Soup Kitchen 321 Grant Avenue: Saturday I :00 PM - 2:00 PM
Mt. Olive Baptist Church 216 Liberty Street: 3rd Saturday 12:00 PM - 2:00 PM
Crescent Ave Presbyterian Church 716 Watchung Avenue: Tuesday at 11:30 AM

FOOD PANTRIES

(non-perishable food- may include meat, bread & fresh vegetables)

Covenant United Methodist Church 631 East Front Street: Monday 3:00 - 5:00 PM
The Salvation Army 615 Watchung Avenue: Tuesday thru Thursday 9:30- 11:30AM
SHEELD/Shiloh Food Pantry 515 West 4th Street: 3rd & 4th Saturday 9:00AM - 12:00PM
New Covenant Church 225 East 7th Street: 1st & 3rd Saturday 9:00 AM- 1:00 PM
& Farmers Market 1st Wednesday 9:00 AM - 12:00 PM
Joanne Hollis Gardens Community Center - 543 W. Third St:
3rd Thursday (10:00 - 4:00 PM) (lunch break 12 PM to 1 PM)
Church of the Living God 434 E. 4th Street: 3rd Saturday 9:00 AM - 1:00 PM
Community Church of God 417 West 6th Street: 3rd Saturday 8:30 - 10:30 AM
El Centro Hispano Americano *525* East Front Street: Tuesday 10:00 AM - 11:00 AM
Bianca Flowers, Inc. 145 Park Avenue: 2nd, 3rd & 4th Tuesday 10:00 AM - 12 Noon
Greater Refuge Church of Christ 600 Grant Avenue: 2nd & 4th Tuesday 2:00 – 4:00 PM
Plainfield YMCA Food Security Project Lot 7 near Scott Drugs:
Second and Fourth Thursday - 10:00 AM -12:00 PM
Crescent Ave Presbyterian Church - Bag lunches every weekday, except Tuesdays from 10am - 10:30am

Meals on Wheels

If you are in need of a home delivered meal and reside in Union County, you may be eligible if you meet the following criteria:

• 60 years or older - • Unable to shop for yourself
• Unable to prepare a meal for yourself

Please call Meals on Wheels at 908-486-5100. You must provide your name, address, phone number and date of birth in order to process your request.

CHILDREN'S CORNER

Parents, please read this to your child(ren).

Parable of the Ten Bridesmaids

Theme: Be prepared to meet Jesus

Object: Bells -- one per child; flashlight

Scripture: Matthew 25: 1-13

Summary of this sermon...
Be prepared to meet Jesus by being wise and well-prepared like the five bridesmaids in Jesus' parable. Just as we prepare for natural disasters, we must prepare to meet Jesus by inviting Him into our hearts. Jesus teaches us to be ready for His return in Matthew 25:1-13. Through fun activities and prayer, kids learn the importance of being prepared to meet Jesus face to face.

Before you begin, give each child a bell. Have kids hold the bell as still as possible until you give them further instructions.

Wow! In the past year we've heard about many natural disasters in our world, such as floods, hurricanes, earthquakes, tsunamis, tornadoes, and fires. One thing that we hear over and over again these days is that it's very important for us to be prepared in case of an emergency.

I remember when I was in school, we used to have disaster drills. Sometimes it was a fire drill. They would ring the school bell three times. (Invite kids to ring their bells three times.) All of the students lined up and marched outside the school building to a safe place. When they were sure it was safe, they rang the bell two times and the students returned to their classrooms. (Invite kids to ring their bells two times.) If there was a tornado drill, they rang the bell four times. (Invite kids to ring their bells four times.) The students lined up and marched to a safe room in the center of the building where they would "duck and cover." (Invite kids to practice ducking and covering.) The teachers always carried flashlights in case the lights went out. When it was safe, they rang the bell two times. (Invite kids to ring their bells two times.) Then the students returned to their classrooms.

It's important to be prepared when something unexpected happens. In our school, it was important for all of the students and teachers to know the warning signal, where to go, and the signal that told them it was safe to return to their classrooms. In a tornado drill, the teachers had to make sure there were batteries in the flashlights and the flashlights were working properly. (Turn on the flashlight and shine it around the room.) Being prepared can mean the difference between being safe or sorry...so be prepared.

Jesus once told a story to teach us the importance of being prepared. In Jesus' story, ten bridesmaids took their oil lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. Jesus said that five of them were foolish because they had their lamps, but they didn't bring any extra oil to put in their lamps. When it was time to go out and meet the bridegroom, they were out of oil. The other five were very wise and well-prepared. They had brought plenty of oil for their lamps. When it was time to go out and meet the bridegroom, they were ready.

In this story, the bridegroom is Jesus and you and I are the bridesmaids. One day we're going to meet Jesus and we must be prepared because we don't know exactly when He's coming. The great news is, what we do to prepare is pretty simple. We must invite Jesus to come into our hearts. When we do that, we are ready.

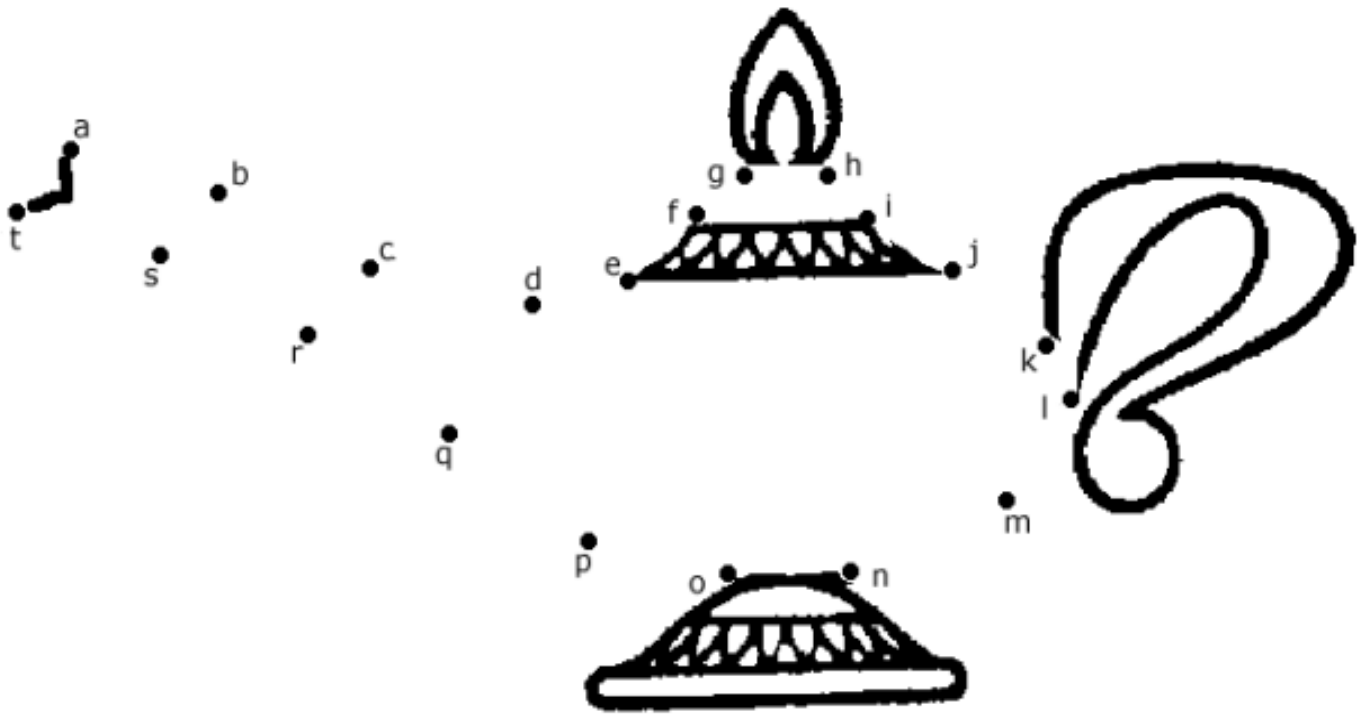
Dear Jesus, we know one day we'll get to meet you face to face. Help us get ready for that wonderful day. In Jesus' name, amen.

Parable of the Bridesmaids Coloring Page



The Parable of the Ten Bridesmaids Matthew 25:1-13

Parable of the Ten Virgins
Dot to Dot



Bible Memory Verse

Therefore keep watch, because you do not know the day or the hour.

Matthew 25:13 (NIV)

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Give Me Oil in My Lamp



Therefore keep watch, because you do not know the day or the hour. Matthew 25:13 (NIV)

Choose the word that best matches the definition.
Answers can be found in Matthew 25:1-13 (NIV)

___1. Ceremony in which a man and a woman are married.
A. wise B. wedding C. oil D. lamps

___2. Where God lives
A. watch B. come C. heaven D. lamps

___3. Devices used to produce light
A. lamps B. asleep C. banquet D. foolish

___4. Not awake
A. asleep B. heaven C. oil D. lamps

___5. Made a sound like a bell
A. rang B. asleep C. lamps D. oil

___6. A feast or meal held in recognition of some person or occasion
A. come B. midnight C. wedding D. banquet

___7. To arrive at a particular place; the opposite of go
A. door B. come C. midnight D. heaven

___8. To observe or look at something
A. wise B. midnight C. watch D. wedding

___9. Someone who has good judgment and makes good decisions is _____.
A. watch B. wise C. rang D. door

___10. Someone who does not use good judgment is _____.
A. asleep B. oil C. midnight D. foolish

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CHURCH ADMINISTRATORS

Pastor Allegra Hoots

Treasurer: Ms. Wanda Breitenbach
Operations Coordinator: Mr. Davaughn Hoots
Custodian: Mr. Charles Rivers

Pastor's Office Hours
By Appointment

Church Office Hours
By Appointment

Newsletter

Editors
Avril Lecky
Wanda Breitenbach
Donna Garzinsky
Hugh Lecky

Contributors
Pastor Allegra Hoots
Gregory Barnes
Daniel Bofah
Yetunde Falowo
Derrick Hinds

"Trust God's Timing and Ways"

"Cast your cares on the LORD and he will sustain you; he will never let the righteous be shaken." Psalm 55:22 (NIV).

One of the hardest things to do is to trust God when His timing differs from ours. We pray for an answer, but the waiting continues. We expect a particular door to open, but another path appears. We wonder, "Lord, if You care, why is this taking so long?"
Psalm 55:22 gives us an invitation and a promise: "Cast your cares on the LORD and he will sustain you…"

BOARD OF ELDERS & DEACONS

Elders

Alaric Tate (Clerk)
Emory Dawson
Bola Falowo
Tania Hemans
Marcia Marsh-Hinds

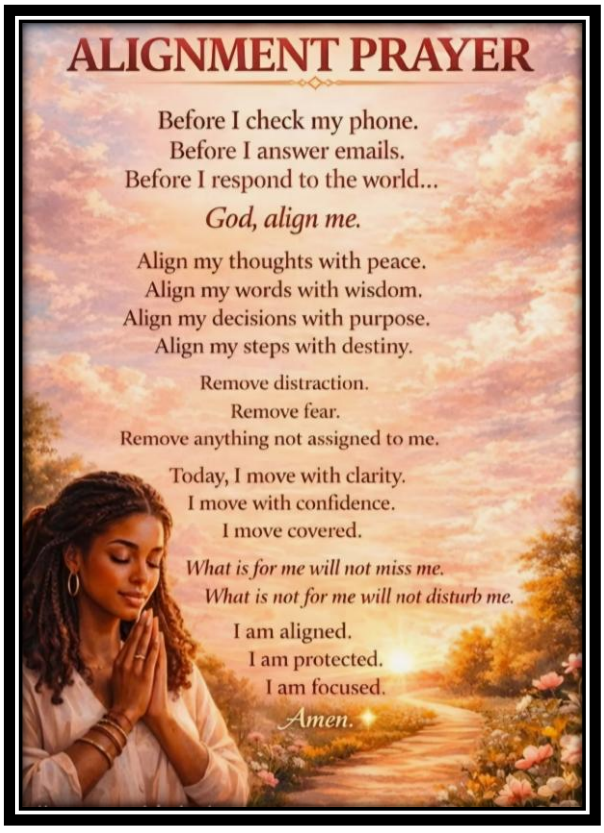
Board of Deacons

Yetunde Falowo, Moderator
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Zorina Bowers
Thelma Fleming
Michael Robinson
Osquit Vanderstoop
Helen Foerster (Emeritus)

To contact the Deacons for assistance call the church office at 908-756-2666.

CONTACT INFORMATION

Church Email:	upcchurch@aol.com
Stewardship:	upcplainfield525@gmail.com
Newsletter:	upcnews525@gmail.com
Church website:	http://upcplainfield.com
Telephone No.:	(908) 756-2666



United Presbyterian Church

525 East Front Street • Plainfield, NJ 07060 • 908-756-2666 • http://upcplainfield.com



DAYLIGHT SAVING TIME ENDS NOVEMBER 1ST AT 2AM.
Turn your clock back to 1am

SUNDAY SCHOOL
Elementary, Junior & Senior High
Each Sunday at 10am—2nd Sunday is also Youth Sunday - (Enter from the Church Office entrance)

November 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
1 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **COMMUNION SERVICE** **DEACONS SUNDAY** **ALL SAINTS DAY**	**2** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**3** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **ELECTION DAY**	**4** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**5** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Contemporary Worship**	**6** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**7**
8 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **YOUTH SUNDAY**	**9** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**10** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**11** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**12** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Contemporary Worship**	**13** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**14**
15 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream**	**16** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**17** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**18** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Session Mtg**	**19** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Contemporary Worship**	**20** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**21**
22 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **DEDICATION SUNDAY**	**23** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**24** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**25** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**26** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **THANKSGIVING DAY**	**27** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**28**
29 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **ADVENT BEGINS** **1st Candle**	**30** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion					

Computer Logon Info —
Sunday Worship: https://www.upcplainfield.com/
Daily Devotion: https://bit.ly/40BeoBK
Contemporary Serv: https://bit.ly/3J7whly

NOTE: THIS CALENDAR IS SUBJECT TO CHANGE. CHECK OUR WEBSITE FOR UPDATES.

1st Sunday Monthly—Communion & Deacons Sunday
2nd Sunday Monthly—Youth Sunday (Except in summer
3rd Wednesday @ 7:30pm—Session Meeting
4th Sunday Monthly—Dedication Sunday

"Persevering in Christ for over 200 Years"

United Presbyterian Church

525 East Front Street • Plainfield, NJ 07060 • 908-756-2666 • http://upcplainfield.com



SUNDAY SCHOOL
Elementary, Junior & Senior High
Each Sunday at 10am—2nd Sunday is also Youth Sunday
(Enter from the Church Office entrance)

December 2026

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Computer Logon Info — Sunday Worship: https://www.upcplainfield.com Daily Devotion: https://bit.ly/40BeoBK Contemporary Serv: https://bit.ly/3J7whly		**1** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**2** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**3** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Contemporary Worship**	**4** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**5** **11am-1pm YOUTH ADVENT WORKSHOP begins**
6 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **COMMUNION SERVICE** **DEACONS SUNDAY** **Advent 2nd Candle**	**7** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**8** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**9** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**10** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Contemporary Worship**	**11** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**12** **11am-1pm YOUTH ADVENT WORKSHOP**
13 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **YOUTH SUNDAY** **Advent 3rd Candle**	**14** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**15** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**16** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**17** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Contemporary Worship**	**18** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**19** **11am-1pm YOUTH ADVENT WORKSHOP**
20 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **Advent 4th Candle**	**21** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**22** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**23** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm Session Mtg**	**24** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm CHRISTMAS EVE SERVICE**	**25** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion 	**26** **KWANZAA begins**
27 **11am Worship Service In-person / Livestream** **DEDICATION SUNDAY**	**28** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**29** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**30** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion	**31** 6:00-6:15am Daily Devotion **7:30pm WATCH NIGHT SERVICE**		

NOTE: THIS CALENDAR IS SUBJECT TO CHANGE. CHECK OUR WEBSITE FOR UPDATES.

1st Sunday Monthly—Communion & Deacons Sunday
2nd Sunday Monthly—Youth Sunday (Except in summer
3rd Wednesday @ 7:30pm—Session Meeting
4th Sunday Monthly—Dedication Sunday

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